

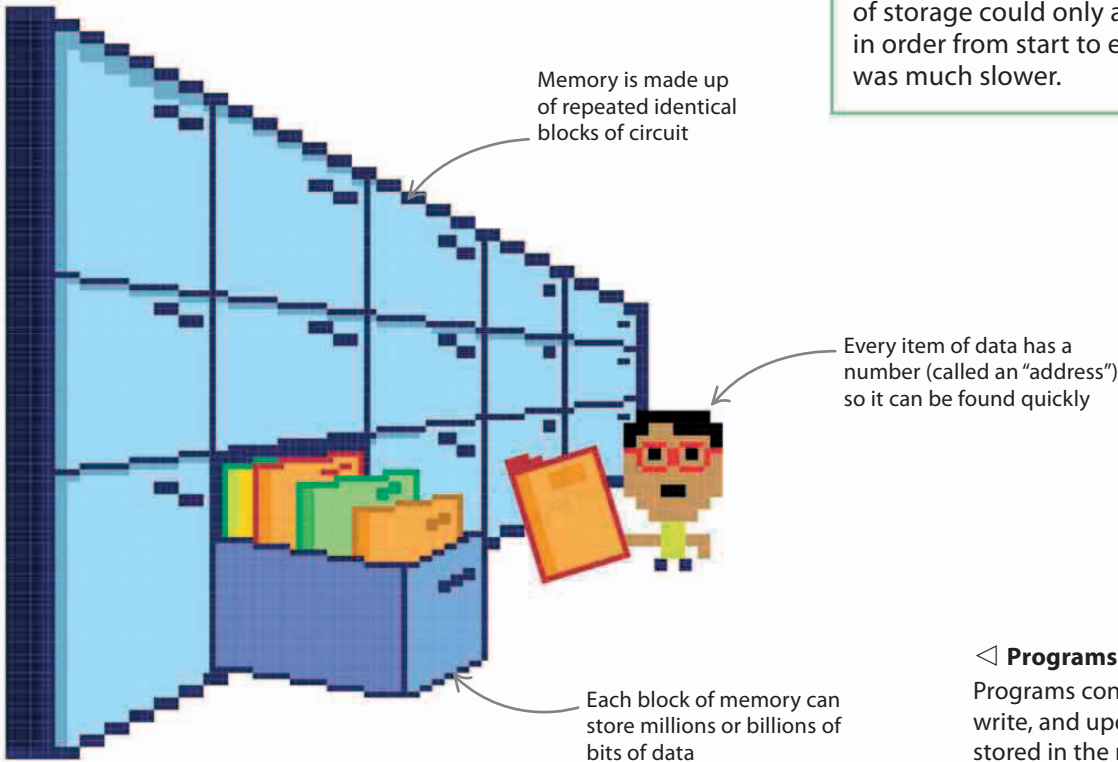
Memory

Like processors, memory chips are printed on silicon. A few logic gates are combined to create a “latch circuit”. Each latch stores one bit (the smallest unit of data with a binary value of either 1 or 0), and many latches are combined to create megabytes and gigabytes of storage.


LINGO

RAM

Memory is often referred to as RAM (“Random Access Memory”), meaning any part of it can be accessed directly. Early types of storage could only access data in order from start to end, which was much slower.



◁ Programs and data

Programs constantly read, write, and update the data stored in the memory.


REMEMBER

Processing information

The processor and memory, when combined with input and output devices, give you everything you need for a computer. In a game program, for example, the user inputs position data by clicking the mouse, the processor does the calculations, reads and writes memory, and then produces output in the form of making the character jump on the screen.

